BRAIN 16

Psilocybin

Compound found in some mushrooms; trials use purified, lab-made psilocybin



CLASS Psychedelic (mushroom compound)

STUDIED FOR Treatment-resistant depression

HUMAN EVIDENCE Controlled human trials

US STATUS Not FDA approved · Schedule I

STUDIED FOR

- **Resistant depression** — HUMAN
- **Major depression** — HUMAN

Phase 3 results are company data. The developer reports two Phase 3 trials met their main goals; neither has posted results or been published.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Psilocybin → Psilocin → 5-HT2A receptor → Psychedelic effect

- **Psilocin,** the active metabolite, is believed to act on serotonin 2A receptors
- **In 8 volunteers,** oral psilocybin occupied up to 72% of brain 5-HT2A receptors
- **Effect intensity** tracked receptor occupancy and blood psilocin levels
- **How it may affect depression** is not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

CONTROLLED TRIALS
LEVEL 4 OF 5

- 3 randomized Phase 2 trials (NEJM, JAMA)
- 2 Phase 3 trials: company-reported only
- Given once or twice, with psychological support

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Effect beyond 12 weeks
- Risk in psychosis or mania
- Peer-reviewed Phase 3 data

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE Not established

ROUTES STUDIED By mouth, once or twice, with psychological support (trials)

PHARMACOKINETICS Converted to psilocin, its active metabolite

SOLD AS Not available as a medicine; state-licensed services (OR, CO)

MONITORED IN TRIALS Depression scores (MADRS), suicidal thoughts, side effects

SPORT (WADA) Not named on the 2026 list; S0 status not stated

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved; COMP360 NDA in progress (company)
FDA	Priority voucher, treatment-resistant depression
DEA	Schedule I controlled substance
WADA	Not named on the 2026 list

REFERENCES

1. N Engl J Med, Goodwin et al., single-dose psilocybin for resistant depression, Nov 2022
2. JAMA, Raison et al., single-dose psilocybin for major depression, Sep 2023
3. Neuropsychopharmacology, Madsen et al., psilocybin and 5-HT2A occupancy, Jun 2019

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